The Heart of the Noble Mahāmāyūrī

Āryamahāmāyūrīhṛdaya · Toh 943 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྨ་བྱ་ཆུང་མའི་སྙིང་པོ།

The Heart of the Noble Mahāmāyūrī, known in Tibetan as Pakpa Majachenmoi Nyingpo and plausibly reconstructed in Sanskrit as Āryamahāmāyūrīhṛdaya, is a very brief dhāraṇī text centered on the great peacock queen Mahāmāyūrī, a protective goddess celebrated as one of the Five Protectresses. After opening with homage to the Three Jewels and to the Buddha as the teacher unobstructed in every respect, it presents a single short mantra, oṃ piśune svāhā, and declares that whoever retains this heart mantra will have retained the noble Mahāmāyūrī herself. In this way it serves as a concise distillation of the much longer Mahāmāyūrī scripture, offering its protective power in a compact, easily memorized form. It is Toh 943 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇī texts, the class of works devoted to mantras and incantations for protection and blessing.

I pay homage to the Three Jewels.
I pay homage to the buddha, the teacher unobstructed in every respect.

oṃ piśune svāhā

If one retains this, one will have retained the noble Mahāmāyūrī.

The Heart of the Noble Mahāmāyūrī is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The homage line can also be read as "I pay homage to all the buddhas, the unobstructed teachers," taking □□□□□□ as "all" rather than "in every respect."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.